

What shall I do with my time?

Ten free hours



A paper

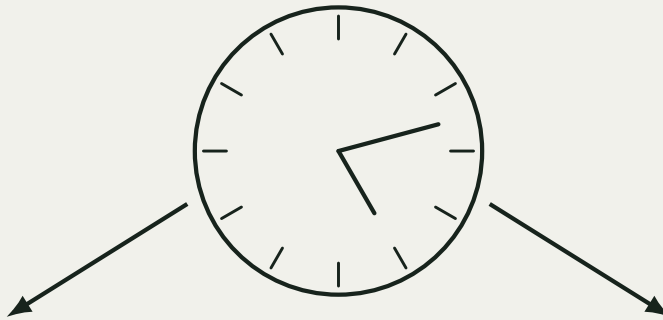


Something new

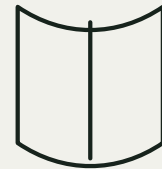


Teaching, meetings,
and admin are done.
How do I use the
hours left?

The same hour has two uses.



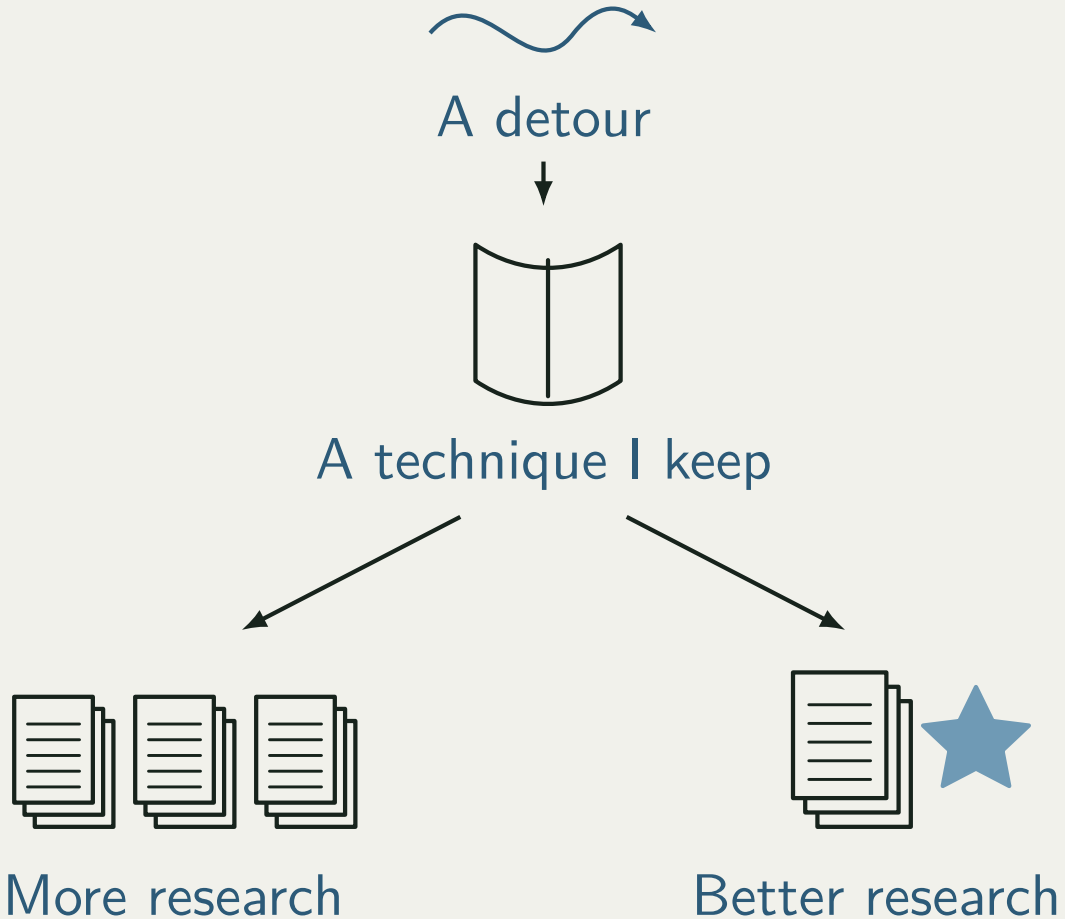
Advance a paper
already started



Learn something
I can use later

Each hour goes to one of them.

A detour can improve later research.



Faster execution.

Stronger designs and checks.

Longer detours leave less time for current projects.

A small detour



A longer detour



Research

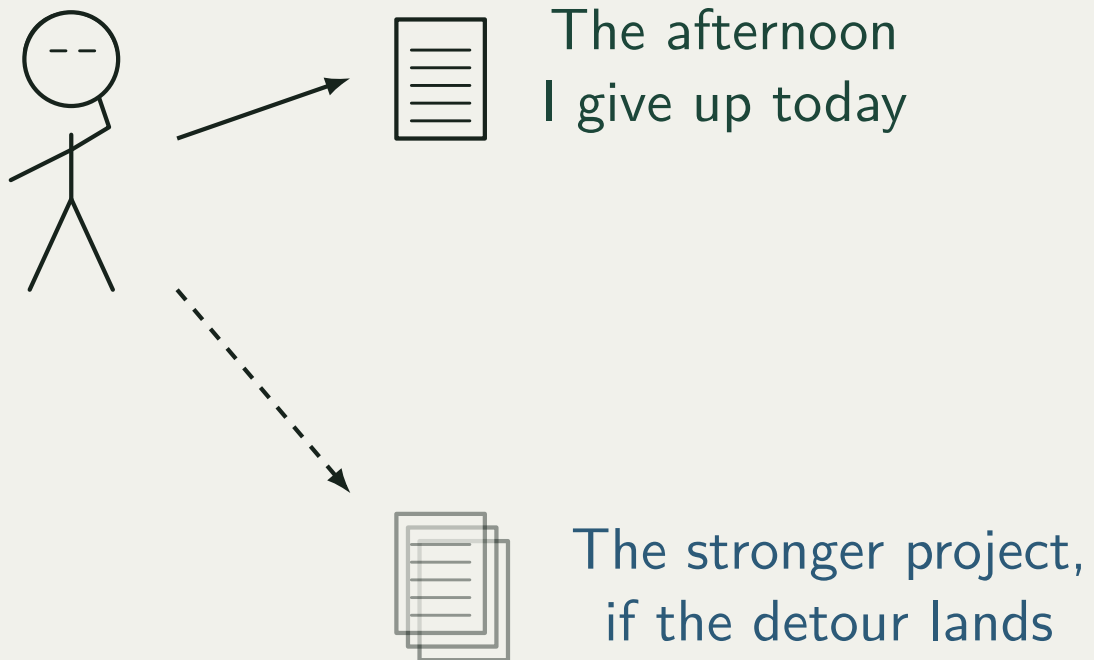


Exploration

The papers on my desk
still need to move forward.

WHAT IF?

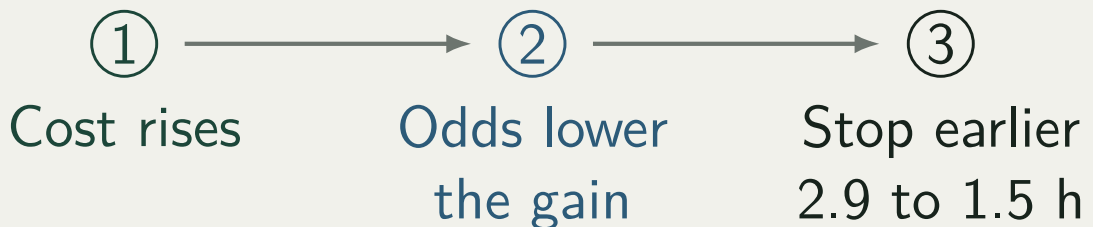
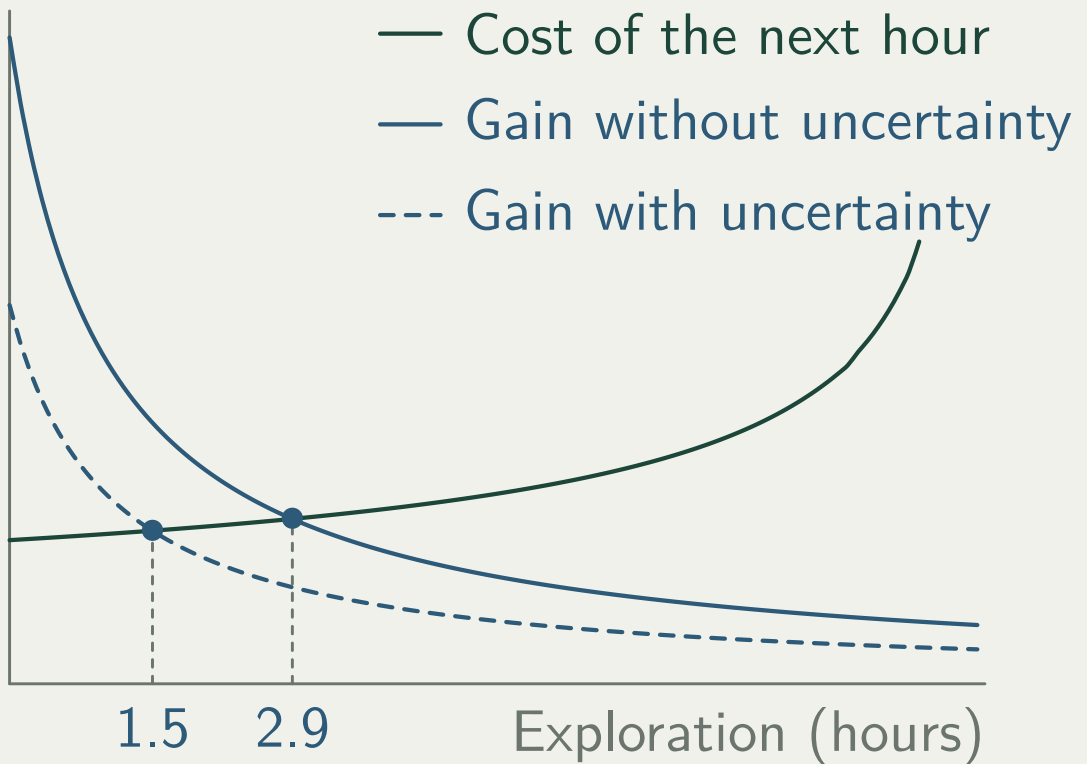
I know the cost of a digression, but only infer its value.



The cost is certain, the gain a chance. Putting the odds too low sets aside too little time.

I stop where the two curves meet.

Value of the next hour



A fuller valuation changes the choice.

Two-thirds of benefits recognised



3.5 hours exploring

Full assumed benefit recognised



5.75 hours exploring

Same ten-hour block.

Current research time also falls.

A fair objection.

Am I justifying my
procrastination with
a toy model?



Possibly.
The hours still have to
go somewhere.

THE QUESTION I KEEP

Is digression progression?



Sometimes the long way round
reaches the better page.

I counted the hours both ways.
The arithmetic is in
the blog article.

pierrebeaucoral.github.io/post/time-to-learn/